noble, Ngathande, the duke of Ngasaraingchaung, sent a request to King Bodawpaya to invade Arakan and overthrow Thadoe Aung. In December 1784, a 30,000-strong Burmese force invaded Mrauk-U. Arakanese forces were caught off-guard and suffered a crushing defeat. The capital was left in ruins as mosques, temples, shrines, seminaries, and libraries were put to the torch. Thadoe Aung was forced into exile; his court, the Brahmins, as well as many Arakanese artisans and nobility were taken to Upper Burma, while over 200,000 refugees fled to the jungles of Chittagong.